Running Without Getting Away

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 8

The belt moved around its rollers, but one loose side began slipping outward. Nib called it running away. Lark stopped the unloaded mechanism. The belt stayed attached while they studied the side-guide diagram beside the actual roller.

“Running, but not leaving,” Nib declared with relief. “Exactly its job,” Lark agreed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **hoped**

“For these short-vowel bases, double the final consonant before ing,” Lark modeled clearly. “Run becomes running; tap becomes tapping; hop becomes hopping. The doubled letter preserves the spelling pattern. It doesn't add a second consonant sound when we speak the word.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try running, tapping, hopping. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read running on the belt note,” Lark invited gently. “Which guide keeps the moving belt on its own rollers?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The belt is running. Sam is tapping the box.**

“What is running?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes Sam's different action?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib seated the side guide while Lark held the belt level. One slow test movement carried it around the rollers without slipping. They checked its return to the starting point before leaving it fitted. Nib wrote a cheerful note about hoping the next test would work, and its spelling suggested another useful comparison.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write running beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept running beside the securely guided belt. No hopping was needed beside the mechanism. Nib's next note would need to distinguish that action from the rather different idea of hoping.